

title: "Microsoft Word Quick Guide" lang: en-US

Microsoft Word Quick Guide

Designing and Delivering Accessible Online Courses. Licensed CC BY 4.0.

Accessibility Inspection Panel Definitions

- Errors: Identifies critical accessibility issues that must be fixed.
- Warnings: Flags potential accessibility issues that require review.
- Tips: Suggests best practices to improve usability. Below are the steps to begin review and remediation of Word documents.

1. Run Word's Accessibility Checker

, A. Review > Check Accessibility. , B. Review the Inspection Results pane. , C. Address each issue listed. , D. Recheck after correcting.

2. Document Title & Language

, A. File > Info > Properties > Title. , B. Review > Language > Set Proofing Language. , C. Select the correct language and click OK.

3. Apply Heading Styles

, A. Select your heading text. , B. Home > Styles. , C. Choose Heading 1, Heading 2, or Heading 3. , D. Do not manually bold for headings. , E. Do not skip heading levels (for example, do not skip from Heading 1 to Heading 3).

4. Set Proper List Formatting

, A. Select the items you want in a list. , B. Home > Paragraph > Numbered or Bulleted List. , C. Use Tab and Shift + Tab to create nested lists.

5. Add Alt Text to Images

, A. Right-click the image.

, B. Select Edit Alt Text.

, C. Enter a concise description of the meaningful content.

, D. If decorative, select "Mark as decorative."

6. Create Accessible Tables

, A. Insert > Table. , B. Select the header row. 42 - C. Table Design > Header Row. - D. Avoid merged or split cells. - E. Keep tables simple and only for data, not layout.

7. Ensure Color Contrast Is Clear

, A. Use dark text on a light background. , B. Avoid using color alone to convey meaning.

Manual Check: Avoid relying on the accessibility checker alone. - Manually verify title accuracy, alt text quality, and heading structure. - Confirm sufficient contrast for text, icons, and charts. - Use a contrast checker such as WebAIM's Color Contrast Checker. = (<https://webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker/>), 212

Digital Accessibility for Faculty. Produced with Technology Innovation and Digital Education (TIDE), Texas A&M University-Texarkana. Shared under CC BY 4.0.